

MUSICATED RECORDS · IN HOUSE WE TRUST

# Your website.

## How to change anything.

No code knowledge needed. If you can edit a document and click Save, you can run this site.

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Written for Eric Martin · August 2026

Your whole website is **7 files** living in one place on GitHub. You open a file, change some words, click Save. About a minute later the real website updates by itself. That's the entire system.

### 1 The one link you need

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Everything lives here. Bookmark it:

`github.com/brucemacvaughn/musicated-records`

Your live website is at `brucemacvaughn.github.io/musicated-records` — and once the domain is switched over, at `musicatedrecords.com`. Both show the same thing.

### 2 How to change words on the site

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Say you want to fix a sentence on the About page.

- 1 Go to the GitHub link above.
- 2 Click the file you want. For the About page, that's `about.html`.
- 3 Click the **pencil icon** (top right of the file). You're now editing.

- 4 Use **Ctrl+F** (Windows) or **Cmd+F** (Mac) to find the sentence you want to change.
- 5 Change **only the words**. Leave everything with angle brackets like `<p>` alone.
- 6 Scroll down, click the green **Commit changes** button.
- 7 Wait about a minute. Refresh your website. Done.

### The one rule that matters

Words live *between* the angle-bracket tags. In `<p>Hello there</p>` you can safely change *Hello there* to anything you like. Don't touch the `<p>` or `</p>` parts — those tell the browser "this is a paragraph."

## 3 Which file is which page

| WHAT YOU SEE ON THE SITE                         | FILE TO EDIT                   |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Home page                                        | <code>index.html</code>        |
| Buy / Listen                                     | <code>listen.html</code>       |
| Live                                             | <code>live.html</code>         |
| Sync · TV / Film                                 | <code>sync.html</code>         |
| About                                            | <code>about.html</code>        |
| Contact                                          | <code>contact.html</code>      |
| Merch (hidden for now, still exists)             | <code>merch.html</code>        |
| Colours, fonts, spacing — the look of everything | <code>assets/styles.css</code> |
| Record covers                                    | <code>assets/releases/</code>  |
| TV show artwork on the Sync page                 | <code>assets/tv/</code>        |

### Menus and footers are copied into every page

If you add a link to the top menu, you have to make the same change in all 7 files, or the menu will look different depending on which page someone is on. This is the most common way the site gets messy.

## 4 How to swap a picture

The safest method — and the one that avoids the problem below — is to **keep the same file name**.

- 1 Name your new image exactly what the old one was called, e.g. `cover-believe.jpg`.
- 2 In GitHub, go into the folder (e.g. `assets/releases`).
- 3 Click **Add file** → **Upload files** and drop the new image in.
- 4 Click **Commit changes**. Because the name matched, it simply replaces the old one and every page using it updates at once.

### Sizes to aim for

- **Record covers:** 800 × 800 pixels, under 200 KB.
- **TV / sync artwork:** square, 800 × 800, under 200 KB.
- Never upload a photo straight off a phone or from a designer without shrinking it. A 5 MB image makes the page take forever to load on a phone — one had crept in and was slowing the site down.

## 5 The logo — read this one carefully

This is the thing that wasted a lot of time. The logo is **not** in one place. Changing it in one spot leaves the old one showing elsewhere, which makes it look like the website "didn't update."

The logo reaches the site through **three separate routes**:

| WHERE YOU SEE IT                                                                         | WHAT IT ACTUALLY COMES FROM                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Big logo on the spinning record, the panel on the home page, the panel on About          | <code>assets/musicated-logo-circle.png</code>          |
| <b>Small square logo in the top-left menu bar</b> , and the tiny icon on the browser tab | The <code>favicon</code> files in <code>assets/</code> |
| The picture that appears when someone shares a link on WhatsApp, Instagram or in a text  | <code>assets/og-card.jpg</code>                        |

### What to do when the logo changes

Upload the new logo as `musicated-logo-circle.png` — that fixes the first row on its own. The favicons and the share picture are *made from* the logo, not linked to it, so they have to be regenerated. Ask Mac (or Claude) to "regenerate the favicons and og-card from the new logo." It takes a minute. Without that step, the small logo in the menu bar stays old forever, no matter how many times you edit the pages.

## 6 "I changed it and nothing happened"

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Work down this list in order. It's nearly always the first two.

- 1 **Wait 10 minutes.** GitHub holds files for about ten minutes before serving the new version. This is normal and it fixes itself.
- 2 **Hard-refresh your browser.** `Cmd+Shift+R` on Mac, `Ctrl+Shift+R` on Windows. A normal refresh often shows you the old page from your own computer's memory.
- 3 **Check it actually saved.** On GitHub, open the file and look at the top — it shows when it was last changed. If your edit isn't there, you didn't hit Commit.
- 4 **Check the build ran.** Click the **Actions** tab on the repo. A green tick means the site rebuilt. A red X means something is broken — see the next section.
- 5 **Try your phone on mobile data.** If it looks right there but wrong on your laptop, it's your laptop's cache, not the website.

### Good news

There used to be a version number on every link ( `?v=20260829a` ) that had to be updated by hand every single time, or the site would serve old files. That's been removed. You no longer have to think about it — just wait the ten minutes.

## 7 If you break something

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Nothing you do is permanent. Every change is saved forever and can be undone in about thirty seconds.

- 1 Go to the repo and click **Commits** (the little clock icon with a number next to it).
- 2 Find the change that broke things — they're listed newest first, with your description.
- 3 Click it, then click the ... menu at the top right and choose **Revert**.
- 4 Confirm. The site goes back to how it was before that change.

Because of this, you cannot permanently ruin the site by experimenting. The worst case is it looks wrong for a few minutes.

## 8 Using ChatGPT or Claude to help you

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This works well, but AI can't see your website — it only sees what you paste in. Most confusion comes from it guessing. Two habits fix that.

### Always paste the real file first

Open the file on GitHub, copy the whole thing, paste it in, then say what you want changed. Don't describe the file from memory and don't let it invent one.

### Tell it these facts about the site

Copy this in at the start:

*"This is a plain HTML/CSS/JS site on GitHub Pages — no framework, no build step. There are 7 HTML pages sharing one `assets/styles.css`. All links are relative ( `assets/...` , never `/assets/...` ). The menu and footer are copied into every page, so a menu change has to be made in all 7. There is no cache-busting version number. The logo also appears via the favicon files and `og-card.jpg`, which are generated from the logo rather than linked to it."*

### When AI tells you something is broken, check before believing it

AI will state a confident diagnosis from incomplete information. Recently one concluded the website "wasn't serving the right files" and suggested digging into deployment settings — when in fact the site was working perfectly and the old logo was simply coming from the favicon files nobody had updated. If a fix sounds drastic, ask someone before doing it.

## 9 Things to leave alone

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- `assets/hero-viz.js` — draws the spinning record. Fiddly. Ask first.
- `.nojekyll` — an empty file that must stay, or images stop loading.
- File and folder **names**. Renaming a page breaks every link to it and any bookmark anyone has.
- Anything inside `< >` brackets, unless you know what it does.

## 10 Quick wins you can do today

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- **Add a new record** to the home page: copy an existing block in `index.html` that starts with `<a class="release"`, paste it below, and change the picture name, artist and title.
- **Change an email address**: search for `@musicatedrecords.com` and edit.
- **Change the newsletter heading**: search for `Stay Up to`.
- **Bring the Merch page back**: the page still exists, it's just hidden from the menu. Ask for it to be re-linked when the store is ready.